

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Thursday, 25 June 2026 · 09:28 IST

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Bottom line: Competitors are aggressively pushing new agentic AI capabilities, particularly in voice and specialized enterprise workflows, but often with underlying weaknesses in pricing predictability, true omnichannel integration, or independent CX analyst validation. Kore.ai can leverage its ABL's deterministic governance, transparent cost model, and proven Leader status in conversational AI for CX to undercut these moves.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

Five9 doubles down on Voice AI with human oversight

WHAT HAPPENED

Five9 launched a "Breakthrough New Release of Voice AI Agents" aimed at replacing traditional IVRs, while simultaneously emphasizing "Human Oversight" as central to its new Voice AI Strategy at CCW. New Five9 research indicates 92% AI adoption in CX, but consumer trust still depends on human support. (2026-06-24) Directors Club News, [CX Today](#), [Business Wire](#). [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

Five9's focus on voice agents and human oversight is a direct competitive move in a core Kore.ai strength. However, their seat-based model is structurally exposed to AI deflection, and their AI is a bolt-on over a legacy platform. Kore.ai's ABL provides deterministic execution and compile-time validation for critical paths, offering superior governance and predictable cost-per-outcome compared to Five9's consumption overages.

Salesforce expands Agentforce into commerce and marketing

WHAT HAPPENED

Salesforce released its "biggest Agentforce Commerce Release Yet," pushing agentic AI into retail, B2B ecommerce, and marketing workflows, with examples like AI-powered fan engagement for VCARB. (2026-06-24) [Salesforce](#), The Futurum Group. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

Salesforce is aggressively expanding Agentforce beyond core CRM into commerce and marketing, leveraging its ecosystem. This creates a broader competitive surface. However, Agentforce's pricing unpredictability ("Flex Credits") and reliance on third-party telephony for CX/voice remain exploitable weaknesses. Kore.ai offers a unified, transparent cost model for true omnichannel CX and is a recognized Leader in Conversational AI for CX, unlike Agentforce.

IBM champions agentic orchestration for customer care

WHAT HAPPENED

IBM is strategically advocating for "agentic orchestration" in customer care, moving beyond optimizing chatbots. They are showcasing specific agent deployments in biopharma and procurement compliance with watsonx Orchestrate. (2026-06-23) [IBM](#), [IBM](#). [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

IBM's focus on agentic orchestration aligns with Kore.ai's platform vision. However, watsonx Orchestrate has a back-office orientation, and its voice/contact-center capabilities are newer and often bolt-on. Furthermore, IBM

slipped to a Challenger in Gartner's Conversational AI MQ, while Kore.ai is a Leader. This creates an opening to highlight Kore.ai's proven CX-native, omnichannel platform with superior analyst validation.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
Five9	(2026-06-24) Launched Breakthrough New Release of Voice AI Agents - Directors Club News	High	Determinism + cost-per-outcome vs. seat model
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-06-24) Unleashes Its Biggest Agentforce Commerce Release Yet - Salesforce	High	Unified omnichannel + transparent cost vs. platform lock-in + credit anxiety
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-06-23) Customer care needs agentic orchestration - IBM	Med	CX-native platform + Leader analyst validation vs. back-office focus + Challenger status

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Five9's Voice AI agent adoption rates and production containment metrics, especially for complex or regulated flows.
- Salesforce Agentforce Commerce customer case studies and any further changes or clarifications to their "Flex Credits" pricing model.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Reinforce Kore.ai's ABL for deterministic, auditable agent behavior, especially for regulated industries, contrasting with probabilistic LLM agents or bolt-on AI.
- Emphasize Kore.ai's transparent, predictable cost-per-outcome model against competitors' consumption-based or seat-based pricing with overage risks.
- Highlight Kore.ai's unified, true omnichannel platform and Leader status in CX-specific conversational AI MQs against CCaaS incumbents' bolt-on AI and big-tech's platform lock-in.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-06-24) Human Oversight Becomes Central to Five9's New Voice AI Strategy at CCW - CX Today
- (2026-06-24) New Five9 Research: AI Adoption in CX Hits 92%, But Consumer Trust Still Depends on Human Support - [Business Wire](#)

- (2026-06-24) Five9 Launches Breakthrough New Release of Voice AI Agents - [Directors Club News](#)
- (2026-06-24) As AI Agents Transform Commerce, Salesforce Unleashes Its Biggest Agentforce Commerce Release Yet - [Salesforce](#)
- (2026-06-24) Salesforce's Agentforce Commerce Pushes Agentic AI From Hype to Retail Revenue Reality - The Futurum Group
- (2026-06-23) Stop optimizing chatbots: Why customer care needs agentic orchestration - [IBM](#)